Immunocompromised Host & Infection – Section Summary

HIV • Fungi • Parasites • Transplant & chemo

Critical Care Board Review • Section 21 • MCQ-Oriented

1. HIV

- Ring-enhancing lesions → **toxoplasmosis** → empiric therapy
- Altered mental status → **CT head** before LP
- PJP → **TMP-SMX + prednisone** (PaO_2 < 70)
- Worsening after ART → **IRIS**; TB lymphadenitis

2. Fungi

- Disseminated **histoplasmosis**; diagnosis by **histopathology**
- Candidaemia/cryptococcus → **amphotericin B** (liposomal)
- Anti-TNF/RA + nodules → **invasive aspergillosis**

3. Viruses & Bacteria

- CMV pneumonitis → **ganciclovir**
- Urosepsis → E. coli
- Lyme carditis → **ceftriaxone**
- Aspiration lung abscess (poor dentition) → **penicillin G**/clindamycin

4. Parasites

- Severe malaria → **IV artesunate**
- Strongyloides hyperinfection (steroids/chemo) → **ivermectin**
- Chagas (Latin America) → **ECG** screening
- Freshwater swimming + meningitis → **Naegleria fowleri**
- Cryptosporidium → watery diarrhoea in AIDS

5. High-Yield MCQ Pearls

- [x] Ring lesions in HIV → toxo
- [x] Strongyloides → ivermectin

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